

The Ecosystem SA (ESA) team is global. The Ecosystem SA's are aligned variously with global and regional partners of all types based on the team member's experience and needs of the region. Working alongside Ecosystem Sales Managers (ESM) in each region, Ecosystem SAs focus on developing Partner relationships as opposed to direct Customer relationships. Ecosystem SAs do participate in direct customer engagements when the Partner needs support in the sales cycle and their account team is not ready to involve GitLab sales teams. Ecosystem SAs will seek to document all customer interactions and as quickly as possible hand off to Field SAs to drive the opportunity with the partner and customer. Ecosystem SAs can provide backup to the Field SA community in support of a Partner aligned opportunities.

Most Opportunity based engagement should start with the ESM and they should identify the appropriate Ecosystem SA to engage. The ESM for every account is listed in the SFDC customer account record. The ESA for a partner account is listed in the SFDC partner account record. If no ESA is listed reach out to the Ecosystem Sales Manager for assistance.

See the details of how to engage an Ecosystem SA in the Ecosystem Solutions Architect Engagement Model handbook page.

Subject Matter Expert Engagement Model

Before you invite or request an Subject Matter Expert for your opportunity, ensure your opportunity is fully qualified. The SME should be requested by the primary Solutions Architect. This will help make sure we're using our resources efficiently and effectively.

Create an issue in the SME Triage Project using the template. You can have a look on the board for current engagements.

Secondary SA

A given opportunity may be found to be too complex, valuable, or risky for a single SA to adequately secure a technical win on their own.

Ad Hoc Support

As part of GitLab's CREDIT values, SAs are encouraged to collaborate with one-another on customer activities to deliver better results. As such, SAs often reach out on their own seeking assistance. Examples include asking questions in Slack channels or Stackoverflow, scheduling brainstorming or enablement meetings, and supporting each other's demonstrations or workshops.

Long-Term

To better support the business and create an opportunity for SAs to collaborate and learn from one another, SA Leaders may assign a secondary SA to pair long-term on an opportunity.

When only ad hoc support is needed without a long-term secondary SA, SAs should continue relying on and collaborating with one another.

Tracking Secondary SA Engagement on Opportunities

Ad hoc and long-term secondary SAs should log activities as if they were the primary SA supporting the account, capturing their impression of the customer interaction. The Primary Solutions Architect field in Salesforce would be used to designate the primary SA, and any other SAs involved in the opportunity would be derived from the logged activities.

If a secondary SA is also involved as a Subject Matter Expert, the SA Assistance - Subject Matter SA Activity Type should be used when logging the activity.

Issue Creation Details

1. Navigate to the correct board for your region. NOTE: All triage boards are located in the SA Triage Boards group in projects broken out by region or engagement model.

1. Create a new issue.

1. Use one of the available templates:

- New activity: use the "SA Activity" template to ensure the proper data is collected and available
- Follow up activity: use the "Follow Up" template
- Security audit: use the "Vendor Security Assessment" template

1. To help the SA group ensure success for the client, the following information should be made available prior to SA engagement

- Customer Information: Customer name, SFDC opportunity link
- Preferred Date Options: When would the customer want to have the call (including time zone information)
- Target Hosting Environment: Self-Managed, cloud or GitLab.com?
- Challenges/Pain Points: What is the customer pain/problems?
- Required Capabilities: What does the customer need?
- Current Tools/Competitors: What is the current tool set? Are any of those tools non-negotiable?
- SA Asks: What do you need from the SA's (demo, technical Q&A, SOW, etc.)

1. Add one or more of the following labels as needed (labels listed below).

Board Label Descriptions

- Open/no label: Newly submitted issues
- SA Triaged: Issue ownership has been claimed by an SA
- SA Demo Ready: Prep has been completed for a customer interaction and further scheduling or conversations can now occur
- Security Audit: This request requires security team involvement, typically upon receiving a customer security questionnaire
- Services Request: If this opportunity focuses on services, use this label to indicate that
- SA Doing: Once an SA signals they are actively working the issue, the issue is moved to 'Doing'. The issue will stay in this status until the SA, customer and sales team agree the issue has been completed
- SA Followup: Followup work is required by the SA for this particular request (example: questions needing research after a call ends)
- SA Waiting: This label indicates that an SA is waiting on the requestor for more information

before advancing this issue

- SA POV: A Proof of Value is being requested or needs support

Triage of Issues

The SA team associated with each region will monitor the triage board and/or an associated Slack channel for incoming work and will contact the appropriate Customer Success team members via Slack, email or phone depending on required skills, schedules and availability. SLA for activity is 48 hours unless the issue is marked with an 'Expedite' label.

Requesting an SA to support Events

Solutions Architects are often needed to support events requiring their expertise. The event support requests require SA assignments worldwide and collaboration between the requestor, SA leadership, and individual SAs. Without an efficient and transparent request and triage process, we risk incurring higher expenses than necessary, disrupting revenue opportunity SA engagements, and suboptimal diversity and inclusion.

To request an SA to support an event, it is required that you:

1. Create a request using the SARequest template [here](#).
1. Provide all required information.

SA Leaders will leverage the SA request triage board to track all requests and assign the most appropriate SA for each event. The following criteria will be considered:

- Competency required
- SA Availability
- SA Location
- Diversity and Inclusion

Following this request and triage process will ensure we minimize the expenses associated with supporting events, avoid disruption on revenue-producing opportunities, and represent diversity and inclusion at the events.

There is a 5 day SLA in place to secure SA participation.

Request Solutions Support from Product

When a prospect or customer have required capabilities that do not map directly to our product offering, Solutions Architect's first step is to explore solutions or work-arounds that would satisfy their requirements with our current toolset.

If the SA is unable to determine an approach that works for the prospect, the next best action is to reach out to the Product Manager. To determine what Product Manager is appropriate, review the Product Categories handbook page.

To be efficient as possible, this is the recommended approach:

1. Gather: Document and articulate the Customer journey
 1. Start by creating an issue on their Account Management Project. Include the customer

business objectives, existing approach, and communication between the prospect (call recordings, emails, etc).

1. Reference running logs in the Customers & Prospects folder
1. Explore: If applicable, document the solutions or work-arounds that were explored with the customer and why that was not sufficient
1. Engage: Reach out to the Product Manager
 1. Create a new slack channel with SA/SAE/PM/etc with a link to the Account Management issue
 1. Be mindful and gift a minimum of 48-96 hr lead time. Properly done, PMs should have at least a weeks notice
 1. Collaborate using the Account Management issue, history, running docs, and shared material
 1. [optional] Suggest an internal team call to coordinate materials and next steps
1. Communicate: Set up a call with the prospect or customer to determine the next best steps.

Request Content From A Demo Architect

The two main reasons you would need a Demo Architects assistance is either with help setting up content/infra for a specific event, or request for a demo that may or may not already exist.

The process are split below:

Hands On Workshop/Lab

The best way to do this is by filling out this issue. You dont have to know the answer to every column before adding something to the issue but by adding your info a Demo Architect will set up an inital planning/content handoff meeting with you. Please note that the general ask is to have at least a week of heads up before an event.

Specifc Demos

First check out the CS Shared Demo Space and make sure that the demo you are looking for dosent already exist. You may need to request access to be able to see some of the content. If you still dont see content for what you are looking for or think one of the demos needs an update please open an issue by following the README here

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/account-planning.md

Account Planning in Gainsight Overview

- Note as of March 6th, 2025: this information is outdated and Gainsight is not the tool used by Solutions Architects for the purpose of Account Planning. There are plans to update this soon.

Account planning helps the Strategic Account Leaders (SAE) and the Solutions Architects (SA) develop a plan to elevate opportunity-driven conversations into value-based conversations that focus on the customer's value drivers. This is a critical step is helping the team evaluate the customer's organization and work more strategically across the territory. Gainsight is a the tool for SAEs, SAs, and Customer Success Managers (CSMs) to manage the account planning

process. Since it sits within Salesforce, it provides a comprehensive view of your customers, allows you to understand trends and risks, and empowers you to execute a strategy to help you win deals.

Accessing Gainsight

- Steps to access Gainsight are outlined on this Handbook Page

SA Role Specific Gainsight Usage

- How to create and edit a Technical Win Plan from Gainsight:
- You can create an objective under account plan. Here is a sample Success Plan to use as guidance:

Sample Success Plan - Flowchart

Creating a Technical Win Plan Using Gainsight - Video

How does an SA contribute to the Account Planning?

A rationale describing how an SA can contribute to the Account Planning is documented here in the Handbook

Collaborating with Other Team Members

It is important to note that Gainsight brings the entire account team onto a single platform to plan, and by having the SAE, SA, and CSM in one place, it allows the SA to visualize the dependencies between the tasks of each individual much more clearly and understand how each team member is working towards the 6, 12, and 18 month goals.

- SAs should collaborate with the SAE/CSM on a Technical Win Plan and ensure that the plan encompasses Workshops, PoVs, deep dives, etc.

NOTE

- The Technical Win Plan is still part of the SAEs account plan and SAs don't have to create anything new.
- SAs should be DRIs on the technical activities for new lands.
- SAs should own technical activities on account expansions where CSMs are not engaged.
- SAs should collaborate with the CSMs on account expansions where deemed necessary especially where there's a need for tier upgrade and onboarding of new teams.
- SAs are not the DRIs of a customer's initial account plan. By the time the opportunity reaches the Account Planning stage, basic account details should have been entered into Salesforce. Thus, the main purpose of completing the Account Profile section of the account plan, should be to capture important details about the customer or prospect, including information about the organization's business, strategic objectives, goals, motivations, competitive landscape, pertinent technology stack details, etc. The account profile should be all about the customer (not GitLab).

FAQs

- How is Gainsight different from Troops and SFDC?
 - Gainsight is a platform that enables collaboration between SAE, SA & CSMs. SA are expected to collaborate during Account Planning. SAs should own the objective of creating a technical win plan during account planning. Troops is used for day to day activity capture for meetings.
- Will using Gainsight save me time?
 - Yes, Gainsight will save time by making sure all teams are working & collaborating in the same system.
- How is it going to help me in my daily job?
 - It's going to help in our daily jobs since now all the account plans by SAEs, Success plans by TAMS are listed in the same system encouraging collaboration.
- Why use gainsight for account planning
 - It's an existing platform already loved by existing teams in GitLab. Gainsight provides metrics, timelines, call to action like reminders. It also has the ability to create playbooks defining different steps in a process for eg: an ultimate play
- How is it related to SFDC?
 - SFDC is still the best place to record customer information for accurate forecasting, creating accounts so on. Gainsight gives you the power to forecast plans for accounts, create objectives, identify tasks to be completed for those objectives. The timeline, attributes section of gainsight is fed back into SFDC.
- What if there is no account plan from the SAE?
 - The SA together with the SAE will create a Technical Win Plan using Gainsight.

Gainsight Example: How an SA Adds/Update a Success Plan

Creating a New Success Plan or Adding a Success Plan to an Existing Customer Entry

```
<div style="position: relative; padding-bottom: 69.76744186046511%; height: 0;"><iframe
src="https://lucid.app/documents/embeddedchart/3f6a8cf8-f63a-4649-b797-c540034c3f1e"
frameborder="0" webkitallowfullscreen mozallowfullscreen allowfullscreen style="position:
absolute; top: 0; left: 0; width: 100%; height: 100%;"></iframe></div>
```

Gainsight Enablement

- Account Planning Handbook Page
- Account Planning with Gainsight Overview and Demo
- Account Planning for SAs
- Using Gainsight in Team Meetings

Additional Reading

- Documentation about Gainsight Go-To-Market Technical Documentation is located here
- More information about how Sales uses Gainsight can be found on the Using Gainsight within Sales page
- Information about how Customer Success uses Gainsight is located on the Using Gainsight within Customer Success page

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/alliance.md

Alliance Solutions Architect: Role & Responsibilities

The Alliance SA is an influential technical representative from GitLab to Alliance partners like AWS, Google, IBM, Microsoft, VMWare, Red Hat, etc. The Alliance SA role also entails communicating technical concerns of partners back into GitLab Product, Engineering, Marketing and other areas as appropriate. This role involves pre-sales and supporting partners. It often involves finding out what a stakeholder needs and wants in real-time, and coming up with a plan to meet those goals. This can include providing relevant suggestions and offering alternative options.

GTM Solution / Offering Development	Partner Enablement	PreSales Engagement	Technical Evangelism	Marketing	Community Contribution
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35%	20%	20%	10%	10%	5%

Note:

These percentages are averages and may vary according to specific partnerships, calendar periods or other natural variations of the work required.

Team Charter and Mission

- Partner Development: Works across the partner ecosystem, helps with offerings, enablement and field marketing, both internal and external.
- Subject Matter Expertise: Recognized as a trusted advisor within an area of focus, with exceptional soft / public speaking skills and "hands on the keyboard" depth. Frequently this expertise involves entire technical ecosystems and technical cultural attributes of partner organizations.
- Sales Effectiveness: Proactively identifies market demand with solutioning. Engages as lead Subject Matter Expert (SME) including pitches, solution envisioning, proposal development and estimate preparation as related to a Partner.
- Internal and External Evangelism: Communicates, grows and evolves awareness of applicable Partner technology, services, success stories, market trends and best practices.
 - GitLab Alliances Strategy: generates ideas for and participates in Alliances group strategy formulation for both business and technical considerations.
- Feedback: Tightens feedback loops from the field to R&D, Marketing, and Customer Success @GitLab. Proactively breaks down silos to envision and co-create products with cross-team, cross-company communication and collaboration.
 - Content Creation:: Develops and maintains content that is easy to find and use, and helps meet the goals of GitLab and its Alliance partners.

Alliance Solutions Architecture Engagement Model

The below documented interactions are between internal GitLab roles.

When to engage an Alliance SA

As a GitLab ...	I can engage an Alliance SA to ...
-----	-----
Alliance Director (AD)	\- Lead and coordinate technical conversations between Partner, GitLab, and Customers \- Enable Partner pre-sales on the GitLab value prop and technology \- Work with Marketing on technical assets for Partner conferences and events \- Drive process improvement related to Support, R&D, field engagement, etc \- Help run

public events such as bootcamps, etc to promote the joint tech and generate sales leads |
Alliance Business Dev Manager (ABDM)	\- Enable Partner pre-sales on the GitLab value prop and technology \- Act as a SME in customer sales cycles
SAE / Field SA	\- Enable Partner pre-sales on the GitLab value prop and technology \- Act as a SME in customer sales cycles \- Provide general internal enablement on partner technology and partnership status \- Connect me with my peers at Partner \- Identify ways to effectively collaborate with the Partner
Customer Success Manager (CSM)	\- Provide general internal enablement on partner technology and partnership status \- Occasionally be a SME in post-sales scenarios to help unblock GitLab adoption at a customer
PS Engineer (PSE)	\- Provide general internal enablement on partner technology and partnership status \- Connect me with my peer PS engineers from the partner side in a services engagement at a customer \- Collaborate on reference architecture updates. Cloud infrastructure evolves and therefore so do our reference architectures used by our PSE providing customer services
Support Engineer	\- Provide general internal enablement on partner technology and partnership status \- Connect me with my peer Support engineers from the partner side in a Support case at a named account
Product Manager	\- Consolidate product feedback from field and customers to work with R&D and drive improvements in product features \- Validate integration implementations as being built with appropriate best practices of the Partner - if the GitLab SA is unfamiliar with the Partner technology area, they can coordinate a Partner resource to comment \- Develop business cases with Alliance Director and R&D to drive priority for new features and/or products \- Gain an audience with a specific Partner Development team to get best implementation advice or otherwise resolve technical challenges \- Take advantage of partnership certification programs for their focus area (e.g. AWS Service Ready, AWS Competencies. \- Seek overall operational excellence advice for availability and resilient technology design.

When can Alliance SA engage other roles

Alliances SAs have a variety of needs to reach out to other roles at GitLab

As an Alliance SA...

| I may reach out to ... | In regard to ... |

| ----- | ----- |

| Alliance Director (AD) | - General guidance on overall business strategy and prioritization of activities in the partnership |

| Alliance Business Dev Manager (ABDM) | - Ask for account mapping activities based on technical requests by anyone on a GitLab field account team |

| SAE / Field SA | - Ask for status and or follow-up if a co-customer of a partner has initiated an issue or request through the partnership level contacts |

| Customer Success Manager (CSM) | - Ask for status and or follow-up if a co-customer of a partner has initiated an issue or request through the partnership level contacts |

| Support Engineer | - Ask for status and or follow-up if a co-customer of a partner has initiated an issue or request through the partnership level contacts |

| Product Manager | - Ask for collaboration if a partner development team has initiated an issue, request or go to market motion through the partnership level contacts |

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/channel.md

Channel Solutions Architecture Engagement Model

GitLab Field Teams can engage a Channel SA when a GitLab Partner is involved in an opportunity and needs presales support, general enablement, or general practice building support. We work closely with our Partner Account Managers (PAM) and Partner Territory Managers (PTM) who own the business aspects of the partner relationship, and foster relationships at an opportunity level between GitLab Account Managers and the Partner Account teams.

Channel SA's ensure that partners get the most value possible out of their relationship with GitLab through their sales and delivery of GitLab's products and services. Channel Solutions Architects (CSA) organize their activities to facilitate partner sales opportunities and mature GitLab partners quickly in their ability to independently deliver customer value.

To mature Partners through their Partner Journey, CSA's engage in a variety of activities designed to help Partners win deals, and mature their practices. CSA activities can be seen as contributing to these themes, Align, Enable, and Expand partner value to customer success. The partner maturity model has more details on the partner journey.

Align

- Coach partner sales teams through opportunities with customers and help drive them to close through the Partner's sales stages
- Coach the partner SA on Technical Discovery that will lead to successful outcomes tied to Business Value
- Engage account alignment activity between partner sales teams and GitLab Field Sales
- Identify and promote existing awareness, enablement, and training material available for Partners to consume on demand
- GitLab Technical enablement based on guidance received from the partner
- Co-develop with the Partner and GitLab CAM a Partner Success Plan

Enable

- Identify / Enable GitLab Champions within the Partner to be SME's internally
- Work with Partner to develop internal lab environments and demo use cases
- Assist the partner with their GitLab certification leveraging Partner Support Desk
- Deliver the use case enablement sessions/workshops/lunch & learns to ensure the teams, leadership and end users are setup for success and adopting the platform successfully
- Regular communication and updates on GitLab features
- Product and feature guidance - new feature presentations
- Coach partners through their presales activities for the partner led GitLab opportunities.
- Advocate on support escalations

Expand

- Assist to develop and review the partner positioned services and solutions and be the customer advocate for our partners

- Develop sales plays and solutions between GitLab, Channel Partners, GitLab Alliances Partners
- Presenting on GitLab technology at partner events
- Help Partner GTM teams identify new use cases and associated enablement & guidance
- Internal Advocacy: CSA is the partner champion for product guidance and feedback, a liaison between the Partner and other GitLab technical teams
- With CAM, conduct Executive Business Reviews

More details on Channel SA engagement model can be found in this RACI spreadsheet.

How to Engage a Channel SA

The partner-solutions-architects slack channel is monitored by the CSA's globally. If you do have a specific Partner related topic or question best handled by an SA, reach out to us there.

Regionally the Channel SA's coordinate issues within the following projects:

AMER

- <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/partners/channel/amer/amer-internal>

APAC

- <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/partners/channel/apac/apac-internal>

EMEA

- <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/partners/channel/emea/emea-internal>

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/collaboration-project.md

When should a Collaboration Project be considered during an engagement with a customer?

In most scenarios, Solution Architects (SAs) should follow the SA process maps and Engagement Model defined in each region to engage with customers in an organised, structured and consistent manner to ensure the customer is successful with their GitLab technical evaluation.

In some cases, where GitLab engages with major enterprises with multiple different stakeholders from multiple different divisions (especially in scenarios with a large netARR) an extended engagement may be required and coordinating regular activities via a GitLab SA Collaboration Project may prove to be beneficial. This can also be the case when multiple GitLab divisions become involved in the sales process, such as Professional Services or Product teams.

Collaboration Project - Internal and External Impact

The following diagram provides a high-level view of the GitLab Collaboration Project in conjunction with various internal and external stakeholders. It is crucial to highlight the internal and external impact, which will be achieved through the GitLab Collaboration Project owned by Solution Architect.

<div style="width: 640px; height: 480px; margin: 10px; position: relative;"><iframe allowfullscreen frameborder="0" style="width:640px; height:480px" src="https://lucid.app/documents/embedded/5cb290db-f70b-4024-9e5c-ca944bc8dc38" id="JKftUP8938-y"></iframe></div>

Internal Impact

GitLab Collaboration Project is highly beneficial to find out the various customer insights-based Solution Architects' collaborations with the customer team. Example cross-functional teams at GitLab, which will benefit from GitLab Collaboration Project, include the Product, Marketing, Professional Services and Sales Team. The internal impact includes enhancements in product roadmaps, product feedback and enhanced strategy or strategic marketing influence. For instance, feedback based on the collaboration project might result in reviewing, improving or even adding new product solutions via Solutions Go-to-market marketing activities.

External Impact

Another critical benefit of the GitLab Collaboration Project is the external impact on the customer stakeholders, communication and strategy. In complex Enterprise environments, project scope and alignment are the keys that need to be appropriately managed. Solution Architect activities during technical evaluation include customer technical validations, requirements clarifications, and prioritisations, which result in good governance and stakeholder alignment. GitLab Collaboration Project provides structured communication between internal and external stakeholders, simultaneously providing a collaborative and transparent environment.

Usage

Collaboration projects take advantage of the Agile Planning capabilities of GitLab such as issues, iterations, and boards to allow GitLab teams to collaborate with customer teams effectively during an evaluation period.

How does a customer use a Collaboration Project successfully?

SA Collaboration Projects achieve their most significant value if the customer becomes an active participant. The customer is able to start realising how easily they can collaborate on the GitLab platform. On larger and more strategic customer opportunities, the GitLab Solutions Architecture team can also assist in triaging relevant product management and engineering queries asynchronously.

Customers should raise issues when they have specific questions, use cases, or topics about the GitLab product and use the collection of issues as a knowledge base for their technical evaluation and as a basis for internal documentation of processes after adopting GitLab.

[WIP]

How does a Solution Architect utilise a Collaboration Project?

Once a solution architect has determined that an opportunity will span across multiple internal or customer teams they will create a project in the <TBC> group on GitLab.com. Key participants should be added as members of the project (SAE, CSM, PS, Product, Customer Stakeholders)

Participants can then use GitLab issues to raise key use cases and questions. These issues are the key collaboration point between GitLab team members and the customer team, they can be used to share architecture diagrams, documentation links, and answer questions raised by the customer.

When using a Collaboration Project, it is important to stay consistent to meet the customer. A Solutions Architect should determine with the customer an appropriate cadence to meet up with key stakeholders to review and summarise the questions from the last cadence cycle. A good guideline for the cadence timing is around fortnightly. One of the best ways to track these cadences is using GitLab Iterations. This allows you to quickly summarise the issues raised in an iteration through scoped boards.

[WIP - summarising a team meeting agenda etc.]

Key Use Cases

- Multiple customer stakeholders spanning various departments or agencies
- High levels on communication with product required (E.g. Dedicated, Product Co-Development)

Benefits

Collaboration projects allow the Solution Architect to track questions outside of email or meeting notes in a transparent way with the customer and allows for easy collaboration across multiple stakeholder engagements.

Customers are enabled to have a long term record of answers to questions in an organised way, which allows them to take the information and use it to speed up the creation of internal processes and documentation.

Dogfooding GitLab early in the opportunity cadence helps to get customers more familiar with the GitLab User Interface and workflows.

GitLab Issues allow Solutions Architecture to integrate with existing workflows in the CSM, PS, and Product divisions enabling increased collaboration across the GitLab departments.

- Context can get lost via emails
- G-docs shared with customer are usually sequential; hard to separate issues based on topics or use-cases
- New stakeholders and team members will be able to ramp up quickly
- Handover to the CSM Organisation is a lot easier for these sort of accounts
- Linked Issues from customers provide direct feedback to Product. Likewise, product can chime in on customer issues and ask questions asynchronously

Example Collaboration Projects (Internal)

1. [GitLab Dedicated Customer in APAC]

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/commercial.md

Vision

The High Velocity SA team is the best place for demonstrating technical talent and product

passion motivating the commercial customer to establish their unified DevOps strategy.

Structure

The High Velocity Solutions Architecture team is a part of the global SA Organization that focuses on primarily Mid-Market customers aiming to lead technical evaluation efforts in an efficient and effective manner. The team is divided into two main geographical regions: AMER and EMEA. Each region has its own team of Solutions Architects (SAs) who are responsible for supporting customers in their respective areas.

Team Roles

1. Solutions Architects (SAs)
2. Demo Architects
3. Solutions Architecture Managers

High Velocity Solutions Architecture Engagement Model

SA Engagement Considerations

- Solutions Architects (SAs) help prospects and new customers that are wanting to buy and consume more of GitLab's offerings. Customer Success Managers and Customer Success Engineers guide a customer's adoption of what the customer has already purchased. Professional Services works with a customer to implement what the customer has already purchased.
- All requests for SAs are submitted using the SA Request button on the Salesforce Opportunity.
- Salesforce opportunities should have MEDDPIC (and required 7 methods applied).
- Compelling events are to be clearly defined in the Command Plan on an opportunity with a positive Net ARR (or negative Net ARR when the account needs deep technical knowledge or needs to be resold).
- When SAs engage, their notes and activities are logged across Salesforce (review the SA Activity Capture page) and the Customers & Prospects Google Drive directory.

Segment-Specific Engagement Models

The SA team's engagement is segmented by the AE role, so that the SA engagement model is aligned with the Sales Organisation's structures. See individual AE's role, area, and segment in this report

Mid-Market

1. Mid-Market First Order (FO): Early-stage 2-Scoping through 4-Proposal for opportunities where a Command Plan and Custom Pitch Deck are being leveraged where an SA is necessary. The goal is to complete the 3-Technical Evaluation prior to 15 days of the Close Date.
1. Mid-Market Named (Key): Opportunities (regardless of stage) where an SA is necessary through the course of the opportunity. The goal is to complete the 3-Technical Evaluation prior to 30 days of the Close Date.
1. Mid-Market Territory (Terr): 3-Technical Evaluation for opportunities where a Command Plan and Custom Pitch Deck are being leveraged and where an SA is necessary. The goal is to complete the 3-Technical Evaluation prior to 30 days of the Close Date.

SA Request Triage Process

The High Velocity SA Triage Process is a structured approach to managing and prioritizing incoming Solutions Architect (SA) requests. This process ensures efficient allocation of SA resources and timely response to customer needs. The key steps in the triage process are:

1. Request Submission:

- All SA requests are submitted through the SA Request button on the Salesforce Opportunity.
- Requests should include a completed Command Plan and MEDDPIC information.

2. Initial Review:

- SA Regional Team (EMEA or AMER) members review new requests. The service level objective for these reviews is one business day.
- The review includes assessing the Command Plan, technical requirements, and opportunity details.

3. Evaluation of the "4 Questions":

- Is the Command Plan properly completed?
- Does the SA have a good understanding of the customer's current stack, competitive landscape, attendees, use cases, and motivations?
- Does the SA have sufficient lead time for preparation?
- Does the SA have relatable experience for this account?

4. Assignment:

- Based on the evaluation, the request is assigned to an available SA with the appropriate skills and capacity.
- Assignment is done collaboratively within the SA Team, prioritizing "two pairs of eyes" principle.

5. Prioritization:

- Requests are prioritized based on factors such as deal size, strategic importance, and urgency.
- Fast-track prioritization is available for time-sensitive requests.

6. Communication:

- The assigned SA is responsible for communicating with the Account Executive to notify them they are working on the account, confirm details, set expectations, and discuss possible account strategies.
- The SA and AE discuss timeline, next steps, agenda for the next meeting and roles they will play in the call
- Any additional information or clarification needed is requested at this stage.

7. Preparation and Execution:

- The assigned SA prepares for the engagement, which may include customizing demos, researching the customer, and collaborating with other team members.
- The SA executes the requested activities, such as discovery calls, demonstrations, or technical deep dives.

8. Follow-up and Documentation:

- Post-engagement, the SA documents the outcomes, next steps, and any relevant information

in Salesforce and the Customers & Prospects Google Drive folder.

- The SA collaborates with the AE on any follow-up actions or additional support needed.

This triage process ensures that SA resources are utilized effectively, customer needs are met promptly, and the sales team receives timely and valuable technical support throughout the sales cycle.

Guidelines for efficient triage process

1: Triage within One Business Day

It doesn't need to be within an hour. You can eat lunch first

- Totally Acceptable Behavior: A new opportunity is created and sits for 3 hours because the Team is busy with demos and life.
- Totally Acceptable Behavior: A new opportunity is created, and someone in the Team's Slack channel says "hey there is a new opp and I would like to discuss" and that the Team follow-up discussion doesn't come for 2, or even 4 hours, because the rest of the Team is busy with other things. This is still okay. The wait period is not a diss to anyone, the Team will get to it when they can, in natural pauses of the day.
- One Full Business Day Defined: If it comes in at 4pm, the Team has until 4pm the next day to triage.

2: Encourage a Second Pair of Eyes Without Delaying Assignment

If possible, two team members review a Command Plan before or after initial assignment

- Whenever possible, a second team member should review the Command Plan to provide additional insights and ensure thorough understanding. This second review can happen after the initial assignment to avoid any delays in responding to the request.
- Once an opportunity is assigned, the assigned team member is encouraged collaborate with another team member or a reporting manager to review the plan, verify goals, and identify next steps. This ensures that we maintain quality and strategic alignment without compromising our responsiveness.
- There are cases where a second review may not be feasible or necessary, such as:
 - Fast-track prioritization for demos that were scheduled with less than 24 hours notice
 - Very specific communication language or skill required for the engagement (which means the request can be directly assigned to a specific SA)

The 4 Questions

There are often 'what-if' scenarios when an SA evaluates an incoming lead. These 4 questions give us the start to our async Slack conversations. Should this meeting move forward if I don't know 'X'? is exacty when the members of The Team will able to add context, and conversation to the Triage Collaboration.

- 1: Is the Command Plan Properly completed? Read through the Plan. Identify if anything is missing.
 - Goal: Make it acceptable for the AE and the Command Plan not to be perfect. Make it thusly acceptable for the SA Team to ask clarifying questions and request more information before the

opportunity is assigned, and before the next proposed meeting can take place.

- Command Plan clarification questions are a great opportunity for our experienced SA org to lead and guide those folks who are in the sales org who are newer to GitLab and/or DevOps. Having the proper time for a feedback loop serves everyone involved in the lead. If we don't tell our AEs what more we need, how else will they understand what to ask in the future?

- 2: Based on the Command Plan, does the SA have a good understanding of the following:

- Current DevOps stack? (SCM, Plan, CI/CD, Cloud Vendor(s), Deployment technologies)
- What are the evaluated competitive technologies? (ex: GitHub, ADO, Atlassian)
- Who will be attending the meeting? Names and titles need to be identified (LinkedIn, here we come).

- What are the specific use-cases they are looking for GitLab to address?

- Why Now?

- It is totally fine if all the answers aren't known during triage · use this as an opportunity to do discovery, collaborate, and gather information together as the engagement progresses.

- 3: Does the SA have the lead time to prepare; is the meeting is not scheduled within 12-24 hours of the request

- Goal: AEs to hold off on scheduling the next customer meetings until the SA Team has enough time to evaluate if all correct information has been collected in Questions 1 & 2.

- SAs deserve time to clarify on Command Plans with the AEs and prepare demonstration environments. GitLab is a large, and ever changing platform - the product is forever being delivered (every month). The SA team requests proper time to prepare so they can deliver the best results.

- Sometimes, a lot of runaway is not possible. We will still have a 'Fast Track' process that allows the AE to both mark the request record in Salesforce (for future metrics) and notify the Team

- 4: Does the SA have relatable experience on this type of account.

- 'Yes' could be the "preferred" answer depending on the account and timeline.

- But 'No' is also a 'Yes'. Solution Architects belong to a learning-focused organization. Less experienced SAs are going to continue to take on accounts where they do not know everything, and will have a chance to learn with the support of the wider team

Expectations when working with an SA

Running Meetings

- All meetings should be planned with clear desired outcomes available to the SA

- Why does the prospect want to meet with us?

- What are our meeting objectives/goals?

- Agenda and list of attendees should be provided in advance; <u>failure to provide this information could delay in the scheduling or declination of a meeting request.</u>

- SA activities include:

- Discovery calls allow for pain to be identified and can be effective way to help build an awareness of the consequences of that pain both for the customer and the GitLab account team.

- Demonstrations align value to capabilities within the product, aiming to speak to the needs of the customer.

- Technical Deep Dives are used to show off a very specific function or capability within GitLab's product.

- Reverse AMAs where the SAs evaluate the customer environment and provide recommendations on ways to more effectively use GitLab.

Post-Sales Engagement

Customer Success Manager assignment is not available for the majority of Commercial Accounts

As an opportunity enters into either the Negotiating or Awaiting Signature stage, the Solutions Architect and Account Executive ought to begin introducing the customer to a Customer Success Manager following the High Velocity CSM Transition Process.

Solutions Architects ought to be primarily engaged with accounts that have active opportunities in Salesforce. When we work with customers, it's easy to build a trusted advisor relationship with them that persists past the end of the sale. In these cases, SAs must use their judgment in determining when to redirect a customer to the proper support channel for follow-up questions.

Below are a few example responses an SA can provide customers that reach out for help after a deal closes. Please leverage your personal connection to them and their company to customize these as you see fit.

Accounts without a Customer Success Manager

> Thanks for reaching out!

>

> In order to best direct your question and provide you a timely response, can you submit a support ticket with our support team? Additionally, I have copied your Account Executive as they can help escalate your request if necessary. Below are some links to get started with GitLab support.

>

> I thoroughly enjoyed getting a chance to work with you and role is primarily focused on our customers that are involved in pre-sales engagements; and being a person of one, I don't want to be a bottleneck to you getting a response.

>

> You can go to support.gitlab.com and submit a new request. Please use your company email address and an account and password will be created for you. There are more details regarding reaching out to support.

Accounts with a Customer Success Manager

> Thanks for reaching out!

>

> In order to best direct your question and provide you a timely response, can you submit a support ticket with our support team? Additionally, I have copied your Customer Success Manager and Account Executive, as well, as they can help escalate your request if necessary. Below are some links to get started with GitLab support.

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> I thoroughly enjoyed getting a chance to work with you and role is primarily focused on our customers that are involved in pre-sales engagements; and being a person of one, I don't want to be a bottleneck to you getting a response.

>

> You can go to support.gitlab.com and submit a new request. Please use your company email address and an account and password will be created for you. There are more details regarding

reaching out to support.

Below are some additional items you can share with the customer.

- Search GitLab documentation and issues with these pro tips!
- If you do not find a proposed feature in the GitLab issues list, please contribute an idea to our product team to improve the community's experience!
- GitLab Documentation covering How-Tos for Installation and Day-to-Day usage.
- GitLab is fortunate enough to have a strong community of contributors where you can search for ideas and issues within the GitLab Forum or moderated subreddit.
- With transparency being a value of ours, we strive to push content daily to both the GitLab Youtube and GitLab Unfiltered Channel. You will find How-Tos and Daily Engineering conversations in these channels.
- If you need engineering assistance, please create a support ticket. Your team has "Standard Support" which means "Next Day" or 24-hour support Monday thru Friday.

On-site Engagement

Solutions Architects are highly versatile and can be leveraged for on-site engagements that require direct access to valuable stakeholders. This approach allows for Solutions Architects to engage with key decision-makers in real-time, gather critical insights, and provide tailored recommendations based on their expertise.

On-site requests should primarily be driven by the desire of the customer. No on-site will be perfectly executed. As a team, learning how to best leverage through iteration on-sites is a critical capability for us to build.

- Giving a demo to a large crowd with various personas that otherwise would not have been engaged virtually.
- Running a workshop where the given customer has requested this to be done in person.
- Meeting with executives in a room to help discuss their initiatives and cast a vision for GitLab within their organization.
- Conducting a Day In The Life of A Developer assessment

Pre-Requisites for On-site Engagements

Any customer on-site must have the following:

- A customer requesting or accepting proposal for the on-site with an agreed-upon agenda
- A predefined initiative with the budget that aligns with a problem GitLab can solve within a price range that GitLab can be purchased. This budget can either come from net new spend or from reclaiming spend where the existing budget and renewal dates are known.

Budget Approval Process for On-site Engagements

Submit a Request for Approval

Prior to conducting any on-site engagement, approval from the Solutions Architect (SA) Manager and Area Sales Manager (ASM) is required. The intent of this approval process is primarily to catch any budget concerns, provide guidance on building proper justification for the

engagement, and create visibility across the team to help build consistency. As the team gains experience with on-site engagements, this may move towards a don't ask, do tell approach. Regardless, SAs are to be trusted to do the right thing when it comes to determining the need for onsites.

To facilitate the review process, the following information should be provided by submitting an issue:

- Customer SFDC Opportunity Link: The link to the customer opportunity being pursued with updated Help inside of Command Plan listing out Technical Details of what is needed for an on-site.
- Estimated Cost: The amount expected for travel and lodging (not including meals) for on-site engagement.
- GitLab Team On-Site Attendees: The team members required to attend the on-site engagement. If a Customer Success Manager is aligned to the account, please make sure there is collaboration.
- Summary of Customer Engagement To Date: An overview of the ongoing activities with the customer.
- Customer Stakeholders/Teams: A list of key stakeholders who will be present during the engagement, along with any outstanding or pending activities on-site.
- On-Site Proposed Date(s): The proposed timeline and agenda for the on-site engagement.
- On-Site Agenda: The proposed agenda for the on-site on each given day
- Outstanding Activities Prior to Scheduling: What needs to be completed prior to the event

This review process aims to help ensure on-site engagements have the highest level of professionalism and that they deliver the intended value to the customer.

High Velocity SA Processes

Async Slack support

In some cases SA support might be required in early stage or not fully qualified opportunities. Slack can be used for answering narrowly-scoped technical questions, providing additional customer outreach materials or helping an Account Executive with a narrowly-scoped customer inquiry. These requests can be served asynchronously via Slack:

- AMER: cs-commercial-amer-support
- EMEA: sa-commercial-emea-support

These Slack channels are considered to be a safe harbor for all Mid-market AE <-> SA communication. When asking questions, please ensure you always provide as much context as possible; including the SFDC URL, and type of subscription (SaaS or Self-Managed). Solutions Architecture will monitor and provide best effort support on these requests.

Avoid using these Slack channels for cases that require technical discovery and solutioning. These have to be handled via standard SA Request process.

Demo Jam

With the continuous iteration and releases of GitLab, it's important to stay up to date on the newest capabilities while staying sharp on existing use-cases to best serve customers. The High Velocity Demo Jam serves as a safe forum for the High Velocity SA team to practice

demoing features, discuss potential customer objections, and articulate value through storytelling.

Structure:

- Demo Jams are hosted twice a quarter as a part of Global Bi-Weekly Meeting as a 15-25 minutes secondary agenda
- Each session should consist of a ~5 minutes demo (recorded or live) and ~5 minutes for team feedback/discussion.
- Recordings are published to the Solutions Architecture playlist on GitLab Unfiltered.

Peer Review

High Velocity SA team recognizes Peer Review sessions as a key activity in elevating the quality of pre-sales efforts, fostering collaboration, promoting continuous learning, and ultimately increasing the chances of successful client engagements.

Structure:

- Peer Reviews are hosted twice a quarter as a part of Global Bi-Weekly Meeting as a 15-25 minutes secondary agenda
- Duration: 25 minutes (assuming two presenters)
- Two opportunities are reviewed during the session (10 minutes each)
- Outcomes are documented and are stored in High Velocity SA / Reviews & Retros

Team Meetings

High Velocity SA team meetings are held on a regular basis to ensure alignment, share knowledge, and discuss important topics. The following meetings are part of the High Velocity SA team's schedule:

Global Team Meeting

- Frequency: Bi-Weekly, every other Monday
- Duration: 50 minutes
- Purpose: Discuss global initiatives, share best practices, and align on cross-regional topics
- Second half of the Global Team Meeting is dedicated to specific topics:
 - High Velocity (twice a quarter)
 - High Velocity SA Peer Review (twice a quarter)
 - Strategy (once a quarter)
 - Team Retrospective (last week of a quarter)
 - Open Topic (once a quarter)

Regional Team Meeting (EMEA or AMER)

- AMER
 - Frequency: Weekly on Monday
 - Duration: 50 minutes
 - Purpose: Connect as a team, discuss any ongoing initiatives, share updates, provide feedback, foster open discussions

- EMEA
 - Frequency: Bi-Weekly, every other Monday
 - Duration: 50 minutes
 - Purpose: Connect as a team, discuss any ongoing initiatives, regional priorities, share updates, and address any pressing issues

Manager Sync

- Frequency: Weekly
- Duration: 25 minutes
- Purpose: Discuss team performance, address any challenges, and align on priorities for the upcoming weeks, months, quarters

Weekly Standups (EMEA)

- Frequency: Weekly
- Duration: 25 minutes
- Purpose: Quick check-in to discuss workload, ongoing tasks, blockers, priorities for the week, and triage any open SA Requests

All team meetings are facilitated to be asynchronous friendly. Therefore, all meetings are recorded and shared with the team. Team members are expected to attend these meetings regularly, or review and contribute to the discussions and share relevant information asynchronously

Paid Time Off

High Velocity SA team members are strongly encouraged to take time off as part of GitLab's paid time off policy. Taking off can be intimidating as we may support multiple customers at any given time.

To best support our customers, consider the following:

1. Create a PTO coverage issue A PTO coverage issue may not always be required but here are a couple guiding examples on when to create one:
 - Customers are running an active trial and may need technical guidance.
 - Leaving for more than 2 weeks and need to distribute the workload across the team.
2. Announce your time off to your team and, share the PTO Coverage issue link, and communicate any expected coverage requirements.

Team Links

- Dashboards - Open Requests and Key Metrics by Geo
 - COMM AMER SA Dashboard
 - COMM EMEA SA Dashboard
- Solutions Architect GitLab Group - Used to share things across Solutions Architects such as links to demos, snippets, training, etc.
- Customer Success Tools - Used to store customer success automation and migration tools.
- High Velocity SA Initiatives- Initiatives specific for High Velocity Solutions Architecture Organization.

- SA Leadership Initiatives- Initiatives by the wider Solutions Architecture Organization.
- FIRE Collaborations - Used to track collaborations.
- Guided Explorations on GitLab - Used to create and store example production projects with customers.
- Customer & Prospects Drive - Used to store all customer files such as notes, etc.
- YouTube Playlist - Used to store saved videos by the SA team.

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/ecosystem.md

To request assistance from an ESA, you should reach out to the team in the ecosystem-solutions-architects internal Slack channel. Mention any team member to start a 1:1 thread. Using this single work queue helps the team cover for each other and allows tracking issues to be created from the channel. Direct Messages (DMs) may be moved to this public channel.

For issues, the ESA team leverages the following labels: \~Partner-SA, \~Partner Region-AMER|APAC|EMEA, and Partner-Acct-.

Most opportunity-based engagement should begin with the Ecosystem Sales Manager (ESM), who should identify the appropriate ESA to engage. The ESM for every account can be found in the Salesforce (SFDC) customer account record. The ESA for a partner account is listed in the SFDC partner account record. If no ESA is listed, reach out to the ESM for assistance. Details on how to engage an Ecosystem SA can be found on the Ecosystem Solutions Architect Engagement Model handbook page.

The Ecosystem SA team is global. Ecosystem SAs are aligned with global and regional partners of all types, based on the team member's experience and the needs of the region.

Ecosystem Solutions Architect: Role & Responsibilities

The ESA's vision and strategy focus on increasing partner contribution to revenue, elevating services capability value, and fostering a commitment to invest with GitLab. This is achieved through "Partner Activation," which refines the previous "Partner Capability Journey" to focus on measurable outcomes benefiting GitLab, partners, and customers.

The key activation pillars are:

Contribution Activation: Qualifying use cases for GitLab, pitching value propositions and demos, and articulating ROI calculations. This leads to converting partner relationships into qualified pipeline and closed revenue.

Commitment Activation: Creating differentiated service offerings, joint Go-To-Market (GTM) collateral and events, and co-creating contributions. This translates to transforming technical knowledge into artifacts demonstrating partner investment in GitLab.

Capability Activation: Scaling GitLab Professional Services, facilitating customer use case adoption, and serving vertical markets. This elevates partner services competency to deliver successful customer implementations.

Activation methods include self-serve resources, technical selling workshops, joint account planning, partner-led demos, Champions programs, service and solution development,

certifications, and hands-on labs. Health is monitored through metrics such as deal registrations, win rates, revenue growth, the number of generated technical artifacts, service attach registrations, customer health scores, and expansion rates.

An ESA-driven Partner Activation Plan (PAP) is a crucial component of the overall business plan owned by the Ecosystem Sales Manager (ESM). This plan outlines the technical partnership's summary, current and future capability state, partner organization structure, activation strategies, and timelines.

Overall, Ecosystem SAs aim to transition partners from passive awareness to active participation and ultimately to leading high-value activities like partner-sourced revenue, deal registrations, and solution development. Success is defined by engagement outcomes, ranging from low-value activities like attending enablement sessions to high-value activities like developing third-party integrations and contributing code to GitLab.

When working with Strategic Alliance Partners, the Ecosystem SA acts as an influential technical representative from GitLab. This involves pre-sales activities, driving partner solutions, and joint GTM initiatives. Key responsibilities include Partner GTM activities like identifying market demand, engaging business leaders for proposal development, and working across partners to develop joint solutions and enablement. They serve as Subject Matter Experts, possessing both soft skills and hands-on technical depth. They are involved in Internal and External Evangelism of partner technology, success stories, and market trends. They contribute to GitLab Strategy formulation for both business and technical considerations. They also assist with Content Curation with the Partner Enablement team.

ESA Opportunity Responsibility

On GitLab Sourced Opportunities, which are new opportunities sourced by a direct account team where a partner may be involved, the direct account SA owns the technical responsibility. The ESA is there to support the progression of the deal by enabling the aligned Partner account team to collaborate technically with the GitLab SA.

On Partner Sourced Opportunities, where a partner sources a new opportunity, the Ecosystem SA takes responsibility to enable the partner if they need assistance to progress the opportunity, even speaking directly to prospects to enable the partner on Discovery and Demo practices. The Ecosystem team encourages the partner to submit a Deal Registration. Ecosystem SAs participate in direct customer engagements when the Partner needs support in the sales cycle and their account team is not ready to involve GitLab sales teams.

ESAs seek to document all customer interactions and quickly hand off partner-aligned opportunities to Field SAs early in the sales cycle as possible to drive the opportunity with the partner and customer. The ESA will not retain primary opportunity responsibility beyond GitLab deal Stage 2 unless approved by both the Global Ecosystem SA Manager and the Regional SA Manager. This handoff process is a key point of integration with the Field SA team. ESAs can also provide backup to the Field SA community in support of partner-aligned opportunities.

MBO Guidelines

The charter of the Global Ecosystem Team is to develop a partner ecosystem that can scale the number and size of GitLab opportunities, engage with customers for rapid and widespread

adoption, and create GTM solutions driving mutual revenue growth. This indirect path to GitLab revenue necessitates an objectives-based compensation model for the team, including ESAs.

25% of the variable Bonus component of ESA compensation is awarded based on the completion of quarterly SMART Objectives. Approximately four quarterly SMART Objectives are assigned by the Ecosystem SA Manager to each Ecosystem team member. These objectives vary quarter over quarter within major themes to align with changing business needs. Payout is a single payment after the quarter concludes. The MBO payout evaluation is holistic, with different percentages awarded based on whether the team member does not meet (0%), meets some (75%), meets majority (100%), or exceeds majority (110%) of expectations.

MBO Categories for FY26 have been established. These categories include:

Partner Activation: Develop and implement Partner Activation Plans to systematically advance partner capability maturity, focusing on structured approaches aligned with Partner Business Plans from Ecosystem Sales Managers and directly supporting revenue/growth objectives.

Technical Sales Readiness: Elevate partner technical sales capabilities through a structured program, aiming to generate qualified pipeline and revenue contribution. This involves developing standardized enablement materials, tracking conversion of enablement to partner-led opportunities, and supporting partners in landing Ultimate \+ Duo and Premium offers.

Partner Services Capability: Accelerate customer onboarding and adoption by integrating partner services offerings into customer account relationships. Focus areas include partner attach rates, CAPs Program participation, subcontracting, greater coordination with GitLab Professional Services, and enabling partners to deliver high-quality implementation services.

Champions Program: Leverage the GitLab Champions program to drive high-value technical investment and advocacy from partner technical resources. This includes driving participation in certification and advocacy programs, cultivating technical champions, and creating a network of GitLab experts across the partner ecosystem.

Partner Activation

Partner Activation Planning

The primary content the team leverages for activating partner team members to be able to effectively pitch and demo GitLab is the Partner Onboarding Workflow & Enablement Resource (POWER) guide.

A well 30-60-90 day plan for partner onboarding is being developed in this Onboarding Blueprint. It provides a concise approach to consume the content from the POWER guide above.

DRIVE the Champions Program

The GitLab Partner Champions program is described on its own handbook page which includes the overall vision of the program as well as the onboarding process for new Champions. A collaboration group and project have been established at a public group [here](#).

In general to maintain the program over time we seek to:

1. Distribute Champions call responsibilities
2. Rationalize the active Champions participants

3. Implement expectations for Champions
4. Validate the value of the program to GitLab
5. Enable Champions collaboration and call session topics

ESA Processes

The Streamlined Portal for ESA Authored Content (SPEAC)

Highspot is the content management system in use at GitLab. Each major team at GitLab has access to two spots. For the Global Ecosystems team, we control "Team Spot: Global Ecosystems" and "Global Ecosystems." The Global Ecosystems spot is the internally public facing spot at GitLab and is curated and maintained by Partner Enablement and other leadership. The Team Spot Global Ecosystems is the spot the Ecosystem SA team can leverage.

For a video walkthrough of adding content to Highspot, watch this short 7.5 minute video.

mermaid

flowchart TD

subgraph "Content Creation"

note1["Identify the content item you want to store and share.
Can be Google Docs, file uploads, or any URL."]

A1[Google Docs] --> A[Content]

A2[Google Slides] --> A

A3[GitLab Handbook] --> A

A4[GitLab Projects] --> A

A5[Zoom Recordings] --> A

A6[Web URLs] --> A

end

subgraph "Private Team Spot: Global Ecosystem"

note2["Upload your content to our private team spot
to store and manage it.
The Team Spot is private.
Only ESAs can see the content here."]

A --> B[Create Asset in Team Spot: Global Ecosystems]

B --> C{Violate Policy?}

C -->|Yes| D[Add Requ